Gmail

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Surrender, especially this week

1 message

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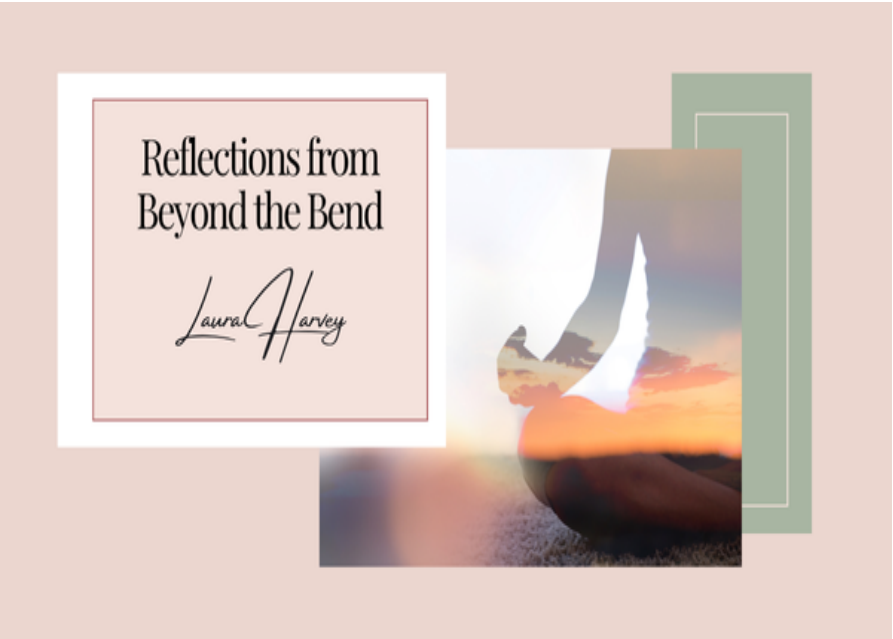
BEYOND THE BEND YOGA



Hello Laura

As Christmas approaches, I've been thinking about the concept of surrender, not as an idea or something to strive for, but as something lived and felt. Surrender is something that has revealed itself to me slowly over time, not all at once, and certainly not without some resistance along the way. This week, it feels especially present, and I wanted to share a few reflections with you.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

Softening into Surrender

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

I have been thinking a lot about surrender lately, not as a theory, but as a very lived and sometimes uncomfortable concept. It has always been part of my teaching and my practice, yet only in the last few years have I begun to understand more fully what it asks of me and what it quietly gives back in return.

In my earlier years, I thought surrender meant letting things fall apart or stepping away from responsibility, but I see now that it is neither of those things. For me, surrender tends to appear when pushing stops working, when effort no longer brings clarity, and when trying to manage everything quietly becomes exhausting in a way that can no longer be ignored.

There is a particular tiredness that I believe often comes with midlife, and it is not the kind that a nap or a good night’s sleep can fix. It is deeper than that, and it comes from years of holding things together, making things work, staying functional, and remaining composed even when things feel heavy. Surrender often enters right there, not as a dramatic moment, but as a quiet realization that says, I cannot keep meeting life in this way.

I do not experience surrender as giving up. I experience it as releasing the need to force answers or outcomes. It is the moment I stop trying to move the mountain and instead begin to notice how much energy that effort has been costing me. Sometimes nothing on the outside changes right away, and at times nothing changes at all, but something inside begins to soften, and that softening matters more than we often realize.

What continues to surprise me is what comes after that softening. When I stop bracing, there is often more clarity than I expect. Decisions begin to feel simpler, not because they are easy, but because I trust myself more. I listen differently, respond rather than react, and notice small moments of beauty that I once rushed past. These shifts may seem subtle, but they change how it feels to live inside our own lives.

For me, surrender rarely happens through thinking alone. It happens in the body. I notice it when my breath drops lower without effort, when my shoulders release, and when my jaw lets go on its own. Gentle movement, stillness, and breath create the conditions for this without demanding anything from me, and they remind my nervous system that it is safe to stop holding everything so tightly.

If surrender feels tender or out of reach right now, I do not believe it needs to come as a big decision or dramatic turning point. Sometimes it looks very ordinary, like letting go of the idea that you should be further along by now, allowing yourself to rest without explanation, or admitting quietly that something no longer fits.

I do not believe surrender makes us passive. I believe it makes us honest, and from that honesty comes a different kind of strength, one that is quiet and steady, that does not need to prove anything, and that knows when to soften and when to act. This is not about arriving anywhere new, but about changing how we meet what is already here.

OUR WEEKLY PRACTICE:

Moving Gently Through This Week

This is not a checklist or something to get right. It is simply an invitation you can return to once, or many times, or not at all.

- Once a day, wherever you happen to be, pause for a moment and place a hand somewhere grounding. Take one slow breath in and a slightly longer breath out, and quietly ask yourself what you might be holding that could loosen, even just a little, allowing the question itself to do the work.
- Each day, notice one small place where you are pushing, whether internally or externally, and see what happens if you ease off by just 10 percent rather than trying to fix or solve anything.
- At least once this week, let your body choose what it needs instead of your mind, whether that looks like rest, movement, quiet, or space, and see if you can trust that choice without second guessing it.
- On Christmas Day, or whichever day feels most charged for you this week, take one minute to step away, feel your feet on the ground, take a slow breath, and remind yourself that you are allowed to be exactly as you are today.
- Before sleep, choose one thing you are willing to let rest until tomorrow, knowing that it does not need to be resolved right now, and allow your body to settle.

Surrender does not mean disengaging from life. It means staying present without force. This week does not need to be joyful, meaningful, or peaceful to be enough. It only needs to be honest.

A Closing Thought

As this week unfolds, I hope you can meet yourself with a little more softness than usual. There is no right way to move through this season, and no version of it that needs to be performed. Wherever you find yourself, however it looks or feels, is allowed. If surrender shows up easily, welcome it. If it doesn't, that is allowed too. Sometimes simply noticing where we are is enough.

I'm grateful to be walking alongside you, and I trust that whatever this week brings, you already carry what you need to meet it.

Wishing you a peaceful holiday season, in whatever form it arrives for you.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura 💗

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